FOR HEALTHCARE PROFESSIONALS

Reading an OUCH report

What it is, how to read it, what it does not say.

One page · OUCH v0.12.1
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WHAT IT IS

OUCH is a free, open-source pain diary for fibromyalgia and other chronic pain. The patient logs their day in under a minute on their phone, with no account; their data stays on the device. This document is the report they built from it for your appointment (PDF or printout).

WHAT IT IS FOR

Day-by-day figures rather than a recollection: pain since the last appointment, compared with the period before, the days clearly harder than usual, treatments with their reported effects, and what the patient wants to tell you. An aid for the history, not for decisions.

READING THE FIRST PAGE, IN ORDER

1 The top banner
The period covered (since the last appointment of the same kind), the earlier period it is compared with, and the share of days logged. Missing days are never filled in. When some days were logged two or more days afterwards, a sentence says so.

2 "In brief"
One sentence built from the same figures as the tiles just below it: mean pain and its direction since the earlier period, severe days, flares. It describes, it does not conclude.

3 The key figures and their arrow
The arrow only gives the direction of change since the earlier period: ▼ green, the favourable direction for that figure; ▲ orange, the opposite; – grey dash, a change too small to count. It gives neither the size nor whether the gap exceeds usual variation.

4 The curve and the flares
Dots: each day's pain. Line: 7-day mean. Dashes: severe pain threshold (7). Shaded bands: flares, at least 3 days in a row 2 points (or 30%) above the usual level, peaking at 4/10 or more (OUCH's own definition, with no consensus).

5 The days by intensity
Two bars, the period then the one before: mild days (≤ 3), moderate (4–6), severe (≥ 7). Under them, for each, the share, the earlier share and the gap in points, with the arrow (green, orange, or grey for moderate days).

6 The contents and what follows
The page of each section: the "What happened" list, what the patient added (their questions, their note, their leads: in their words, never causes), treatments, symptoms, "Key points" (the 30% change usually taken as clinically relevant[1][2]).

TWO VERSIONS

Family doctor · 3 to 5 pages
"In brief", key figures, curve, days by intensity compared, what happened, treatments, patient's questions.

Pain clinic · 6 to 10 pages
A summary, then six numbered parts: pain (statistics, flares and the 3 days before each), treatments, symptoms, habits, questions and notes, method.

Keep in mind. OUCH describes: it makes no diagnosis, advises no treatment and never presents an association as a cause. Self-reported data, not verified. Fatigue, sleep, mood and per-condition indicator scales are not validated. The report is built on the phone; the name is not stored, the date of birth stays on the device. References [1][2] are those of the methodology note.

GOING FURTHER

The leaflet (2 pages) and the methodology note (14 pages: every formula, threshold and source) are on the project's latest release page. The app is open to all, with a demo mode of 90 made-up days: **maxauvy.github.io/OUCH**. Your feedback is welcome.

Free software, CeCILL v2.1 licence